

Rope Trick

A Jat and his family were on their way to the city. At noon on the second day of their journey they came upon a huge banyan tree and decided to rest under it **for a while**.

The Jat did not want to stay **idle** so he decided to make a rope. He sent his eldest son to a town nearby to buy jute; he sent his second son to buy vegetables, and the third to buy **provisions**. He **assigned** duties to his daughters-in-law too. One was sent to **fetch** water; another, firewood. The third one was asked to **knead** the **dough**.

When he had got all the materials he needed, the Jat sat under the tree to make the rope. Now there was a giant living on the tree. He had been observing the Jat and his family ever since they had **camped** under his tree. He **wondered** why the man was making a rope. Finally unable to contain his **curiosity**, he **got down** and asked him.

The Jat **concealed** his fear and kept on working. Looking **defiantly** at the giant he said he was making the rope to tie him.

The giant was **shaken**. Though big, he was **timid at heart**. He fell at the Jat's feet and **begged** for **mercy**.

"I'll make you rich," he said, and **digging up a chest of treasure**, gave it to him.

The Jat was **overjoyed**. He **cut short** his journey and returned to his village, a rich man.



When his neighbour heard how he had come by his wealth, he immediately gathered his own family and **set out** for the giant's **abode**.

There, he began issuing instructions to his sons and daughters-in-law. But his sons refused to leave the shade of the tree to **run errands** and his daughters-in-law just ignored him.

He had to do everything himself. **Eventually**, he got all the materials he needed and sat down under the tree to make the rope.

He was thrilled when the giant **descended** from the tree.

"Why are you making that rope?" asked the giant.

"Why else but to tie you," said the man.

The giant smiled.

"So you're afraid," said the man. "Better give me a chest of treasure or I won't **spare** you."

"If your own family is not afraid of you, why should I be?" laughed the giant, climbing back onto his tree. "Tie your sons and daughters-in-law before thinking of tying anybody else."

@mocks_wallah

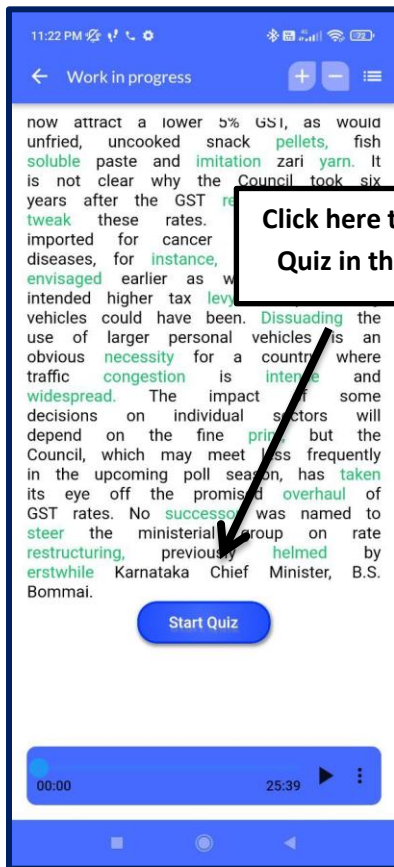
Vocabulary

1. **For a while** (phrase) – For some time, temporarily, briefly, momentarily, for a short period कुछ समय के लिए
2. **Idle** (adjective) – Inactive, lazy, unoccupied, inert, slack बेकार
3. **Provision** (noun) – Supply, stock, foodstuff, ration, resource राशन
4. **Assign** (verb) – Allocate, appoint, delegate, designate, distribute सौंपना
5. **Fetch** (verb) – Bring, get, collect, retrieve, carry लाना
6. **Knead** (verb) – Mix, work, massage, blend, fold गूँथना
7. **Dough** (noun) – Mixture, paste, batter, bread mixture, flour mix आटा
8. **Camp** (verb) – Settle, pitch, stay, lodge, bivouac शिविर लगाना
9. **Wonder** (verb) – Ponder, question, think, speculate, marvel आश्चर्य करना
10. **Curiosity** (noun) – Inquisitiveness, interest, eagerness, nosiness, desire to know जिज्ञासा
11. **Got down** (phrasal verb) – Climb down, descend, dismount, alight, step down नीचे आना
12. **Conceal** (verb) – Hide, cover, disguise, mask, keep secret छिपाना
13. **Defiantly** (adverb) – Boldly, rebelliously, stubbornly, challengingly, unyieldingly चुनौतीपूर्ण ढंग से
14. **Shake** (verb) – Tremble, quake, shudder, wobble, unsettle कांपना/हिलाना
15. **Timid** (adjective) – Shy, fearful, nervous, faint-hearted, cowardly डरपोक
16. **At heart** (phrase) – Deep down, essentially, fundamentally, in reality, truly दिल से
17. **Beg** (verb) – Plead, implore, request, beseech, entreat भीख मांगना/गुहार लगाना
18. **Mercy** (noun) – Compassion, pity, leniency, kindness, clemency दया
19. **Dig up** (phrasal verb) – Unearth, excavate, uncover, exhume, reveal खोद निकालना
20. **A chest of treasure** (noun) – Box of riches, treasure trove, loot box, strongbox, hoard खजाने का संदूक
21. **Overjoy** (verb) – Delight, elate, thrill, exhilarate, make very happy अत्यंत खुश होना
22. **Cut short** (phrase) – End early, interrupt, abbreviate, curtail, truncate बीच में रोकना

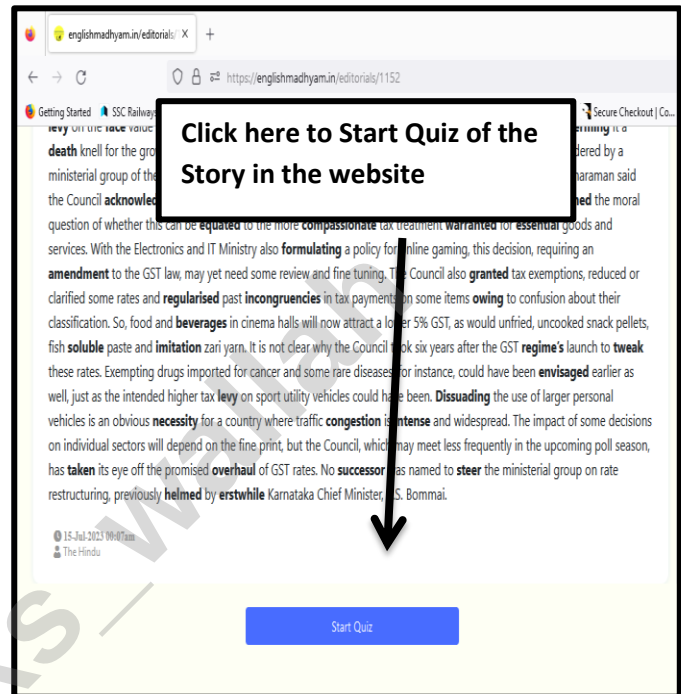
23. **Set out** (phrasal verb) – Start, embark, complete assignments काम से इधर-उधर
depart, commence, begin यात्रा पर निकलना जाना
24. **Abode** (noun) – Home, dwelling, residence, house, habitat निवास
25. **Run errand** (phrase) – Do tasks, carry out chores, perform duties, execute jobs,
26. **Descend** (verb) – Come down, lower, drop, alight, get down उतरना
27. **Spare** (verb) – Forgive, save, pardon, relent, show mercy बख्श देना

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